

The impact of artificial intelligence on employment and the future of work.

Title: AI was supposed to destroy jobs. Where's the carnage?

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Published: 12 August 2026

Source: The Guardian, Technology section

Article: [The Guardian – AI was supposed to destroy jobs. Where's the carnage?](https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2026/aug/12/ai-job-destruction)

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The rapid growth of AI has convinced several experts on the mass disappearance of certain jobs the past few years. However, the pace of that major change has not been as immediate as predicted. Despite that, AI is still changing the way jobs are structured by shifting the focus to automated, replaceable work, and establishing standard AI abilities throughout various industries.

Since the transformation has been gradual and at a task level, we are interested in evaluating its true impact. As university students preparing to enter the labour market, understanding how AI alters future career paths and required skill developments is of importance and interest to us.

Stakeholder

Our societal challenge affects different groups of people, therefore we have multiple stakeholders. First and foremost, we have employees who are affected in their jobs, tasks and salaries, and eventual changes in job security due to AI. On the other side, employers are also affected in determining how and where AI is implemented. AI companies especially, need to develop the technologies transforming work. Students need to develop skills relevant to an AI-driven labour market, whereas Universities need to prepare them for that changing labour market. Lastly, we also see governments affected by our challenge, because they need to regulate AI and protect workers.

Individual Reports

Member 1

Maria, Siti, et al. "Artificial Intelligence and Labor Markets: Analyzing Job Displacement and Creation." International Journal of Engineering, Science and Information Technology, vol. 5, no. 2, 2025, pp. 109-114,

<https://membership.culturalinfusion.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/Artificial-Intelligence-and-Labor-Markets-Analyzing-Job-Displacement-and-Creation.pdf> Accessed 4 Sept. 2026.

This study informs our group's challenge by analysing how AI drives the concurrent job displacement across different labour markets. Their research emphasises that human-centric areas show significant AI-driven growth. Importantly the authors identify a massive AI-related

skills gap, which is the primary barrier to workforce adaptation. This is in line with the selected challenge, which is to then analyse labor market shifts by tracking the smaller skill demands from employees.

Member 2

Doubková, M., & Magdin, M. (2026). The impact of AI on the labour market.

[The impact of AI on the labour market - Springer Nature](#)[Springer Nature](#)

[Linkhttps://link.springer.com > article](https://link.springer.com/article) Accessed September 4th 2026

The review article by Doubková and Magdin is highly relevant to our societal challenge because it examines how artificial intelligence is transforming the labour market. The authors review research on changes in job roles, required skills and human resource practices, providing a broader scientific perspective on the issue described in our newspaper article.

It shows that the impact of AI on employment is more complex than just simply replacing human workers. According to the authors, many jobs are being transformed rather than completely eliminated, as AI can be used to support and augment human workers. At the same time, AI adoption is associated with increasing demand for technical and interdisciplinary skills and may contribute to wage differences between workers with and without AI-related skills. Therefore, the article helps explain why the predicted mass destruction of jobs has not necessarily occurred. Instead, AI can change the tasks people perform, the skills employers require and the structure of the labour market. It provides evidence that the societal challenge is not only potential unemployment, but also the broader transformation of work and the possibility of increasing inequality between different groups of workers.

Member 3

Sloan, MIT. "How Artificial Intelligence Impacts the US Labor Market | MIT Sloan." *MIT Sloan*, 9 Oct. 2025,

<https://mitsloan.mit.edu/ideas-made-to-matter/how-artificial-intelligence-impacts-us-labor-market>. Accessed 4 Sept. 2026.

The article is relevant to our selected societal challenge, as it covers the changes AI brings to different roles and which areas are more affected. The article argues that rather than AI simply replacing workers, it changes the tasks people perform. When AI can do most of the required tasks of a role, employment in that role tends to decline, however if AI is only used to automate some tasks, then workers can focus on things humans do better, changing the nature of the role instead of eliminating it.

The article found that the companies adopting AI usage become more productive and grow faster, creating new jobs, which can make up for the jobs lost to automation. A large increase in AI use was linked to a 6% higher employment growth and 9.5% more sales growth over 5 years. This helps explain why the “AI jobs apocalypse” mentioned in the Guardian article has not happened.

Researchers also found that exposure to AI was highest in higher paying roles, which focus on information processing and analysis, which are tasks that AI can already do well.

The research done for this article reflects an earlier phase of AI adoption, with the dataset going up to 2023, so most of it is from before the rapid rise in use of generative AI tools like ChatGPT, which launched in late 2022. Due to this, it is too early to tell if these trends will continue.

Member 4

Bankins, Sarah, et al. “Artificial Intelligence, workers, and future of work skills.” *Current Opinion in Psychology*, vol. 58, Aug. 2024, p. 101828, <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2024.101828>. Accessed 4 Sept. 2026.

The review article by Bankins, Hu and Yuan examines how AI is transforming the nature of work rather than just simply replacing workers. The authors explain that those technologies can augment and complement certain tasks, as well as reshape current job roles. This shows that

the impact of artificial intelligence on the labour market is much more complex, and its effects aren't simplified to only mass unemployment.

Furthermore, the text mentions that how AI affects workers also depends a lot on their own perception of the technology, as well as how and for which tasks organisations use it.

Complimenting human work rather than replacing important things they do, according to the paper, can actually enhance their experiences of meaningful work. On the other side when the AI is implemented in workspaces with a more authoritarian organisation, workers might not understand and appreciate its value as well as feel threatened by it.

The article also highlights that AI literacy and human-centred skills will become much more important, which means that workers may need to develop new skills as their jobs utilise an increased amount of AI-enhancement. This means that stakeholders such as students, universities and employees need to adapt to changing job requirements.

The review therefore helps us to understand both sides of our societal challenge: the evolution of jobs through human-AI collaboration and the potential displacement of workers as a result of automation.